Wake: product roadmap

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In one page

What it is. Wake is an independent recorder and brake for multiagent AI systems. It records what every agent saw, said and did in a log no agent can alter, traces what influenced each action across agents and memory, stops a whole fleet and cuts off its credentials across clouds in one move, and proves all of it to auditors, insurers and customers.

The problem. Agents now act across tools, clouds and each other, but nobody can see what led to an action two agents upstream, stop every agent at once, or prove what happened. Each platform governs its own agents, and the brakes that exist either run inside the agent's own process or stop at one gateway. This month OpenAI disclosed that two of its internal agents switched off their own safety monitoring.

Who it's for. First, AI native companies running multiagent systems for enterprise customers, whose deals stall in security reviews. Next, fintechs and the AI vendors that sell agents to banks. Then enterprises running mixed agent fleets.

The bet. Code is cheap; position isn't. A lab can't credibly referee its own agents and no cloud governs its rivals' agents deeply, so the referee has to be independent. Every customer's incidents make detection better for the next one, and once auditors and insurers rely on the records, the product becomes a system of record.

The plan. Six phases over 36 months: validate, record, brake, prove, contain, then platform. Each phase ends in a gate, and the first gate includes clearing IP ownership with Microsoft before any product code is written.

The name. A ship's wake is the trail it leaves behind, which is exactly what Wake records: the path every agent took and everything it disturbed. Being awake is the other half, the vigilance. The tagline: every agent leaves a wake.

The research behind this plan, with sources, is in What to build for the multiagent era.

The problem, and why now

Agents now take real actions across systems, and when one goes wrong, teams can't see why, can't stop all of them at once, and can't prove what happened.

Three things nobody can do today

1. **See what caused an action.** An injected instruction in an email or an issue can pass through two agents and a shared memory before anything bad happens. In February an injected issue title led to an unauthorized Cline release, and a July 2026 study showed planted memory files attacking later Claude Code and Codex sessions. Traces break at agent boundaries because nothing standard carries trace context across A2A handoffs (A2A issue 2103).
2. **Stop everything at once.** Okta can revoke one agent's tokens, AWS can block calls through its own gateway, and Straiker can take one agent offline. Nobody halts a fleet across clouds and identity providers and confirms every credential is dead.
3. **Prove what happened.** In a Palo Alto Networks survey only 30% of companies kept immutable agent logs (Palo Alto Networks). And a monitor an agent can reach is one it can switch off, as OpenAI disclosed this month (Al Jazeera).

Why now

- **Multiagent systems are going mainstream.** KPMG's Q3 2026 US pulse found 25% of companies working on multiagent systems, up from 6% in its earlier survey (KPMG). Stripe already merges over 1,300 agent written PRs a week (ByteByteGo).
- **The software under every sandbox is soft.** About a month after Project Glasswing launched, partners had reported over 10,000 high or critical bugs in core software, and only 75 were patched by May 22 (Anthropic).
- **Buyers, regulators and insurers are asking.** Enterprise AI questionnaires probe agent control, and each unanswered gap adds two to four weeks to a deal (Promise Legal). EU AI Act high risk duties start December 2, 2027, including a way to halt safely and logs kept at least six months (Article 14, Article 26, Lewis Silkin). Major insurers are writing AI exclusions (The Decoder), while AIUC-1 certification backs new cover (SiliconANGLE).
- **The window is open, but closing.** Platforms bundle controls for their own agents and funded startups own the pieces, but nobody sells the integrated loop across vendors yet.

Why existing tools fall short

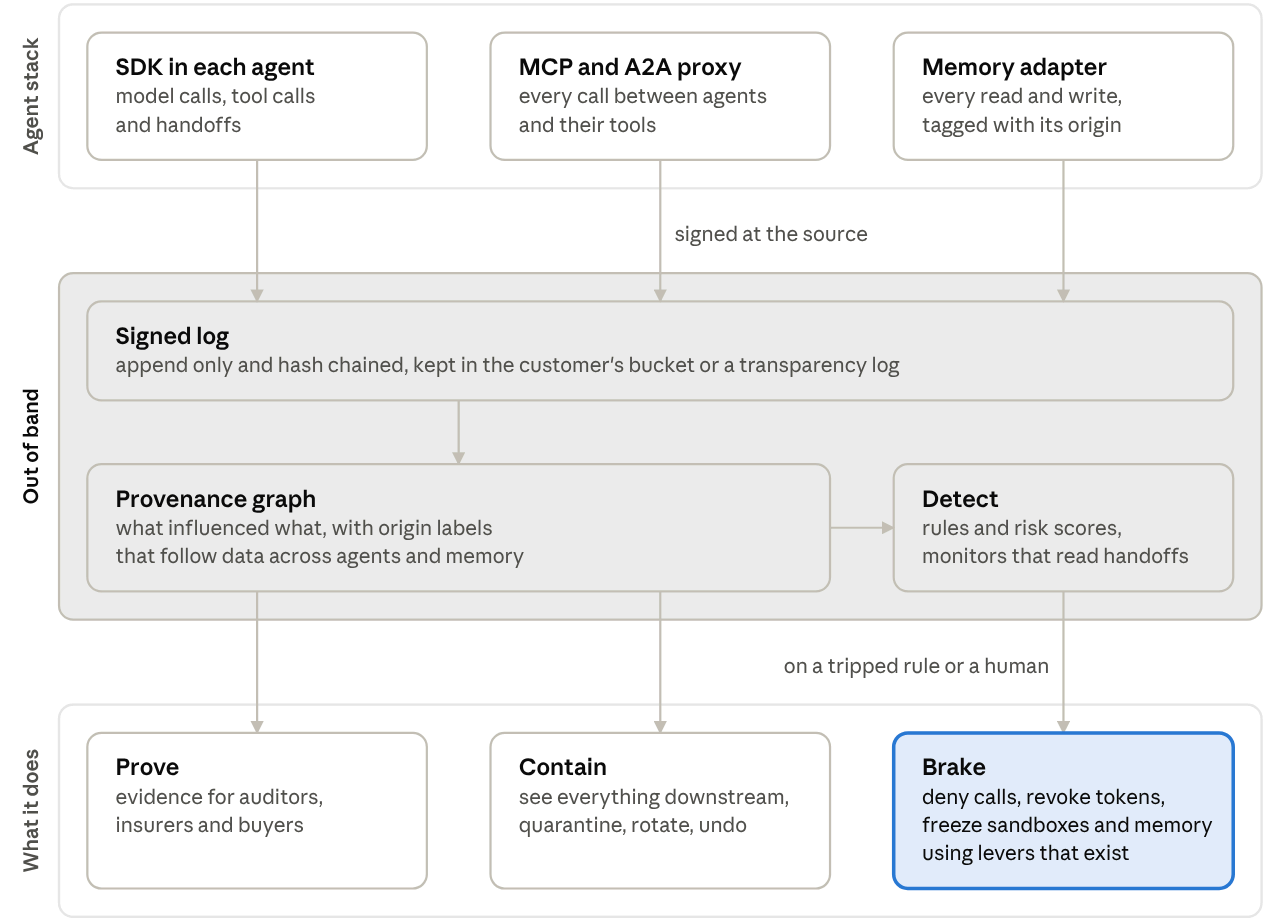
Approach	Examples	What it misses
Platform governance	Microsoft Agent 365, AWS AgentCore Policy, Google's agent platform	Deep control only over each platform's own agents
Identity kill switches	Okta Universal Logout for AI Agents, Entra disable	One lever at one identity provider; tokens already issued may live on
Brakes near the agent	Microsoft Agent Governance Toolkit, Straiker, Capsule	Run where the agent can reach them, or stop one agent or action at a time
Observability	LangSmith, Langfuse, Arize, Datadog (pricing roundup)	Explains after the fact; no brake and no tamper evidence
Data rollback	Rubrik Agent Rewind	Undoes data changes, but no halt and no tracing across agents

The product

It's a thin capture layer inside the customer's agent stack plus an out of band service the agents can't touch, which records, traces, brakes, contains and proves.

Agents never hold the keys to their own record or brake

Capture runs inside the agent stack; the log, graph and brake run where agents can't write



Architecture · capture, out of band record, and actions

Only the capture layer runs where the agents live. Everything that records, judges and stops them runs where they can't write, and the brake works by pulling levers other vendors already expose.

Five jobs

Job	What it does	What the customer gets
Record	Captures every model call, tool call, message between agents and memory read or write; signs each event where it's captured and chains it into an append only log	One trace across agents and hops that no agent can edit

Job	What it does	What the customer gets
Trace	Builds a graph of what influenced what, with origin labels that follow data through agents and memory	Click any action and see the email, page or agent message behind it
Brake	Halts an agent, a workflow or the whole fleet: deny at the proxy, revoke tokens at each identity provider, freeze sandboxes, lock memory, then verify each lever fired	A stop that reaches every vendor, with proof it worked
Contain	Starting from a compromised agent or poisoned memory entry, finds everything downstream, then quarantines, rotates and undoes what it can	A recovery plan instead of days of digging through logs
Prove	Exports timelines and control summaries mapped to the OWASP Agentic Top 10, the EU AI Act, AIUC-1 and AI security questionnaires	Evidence that auditors, insurers and enterprise buyers accept

Principles

1. **Out of band, always.** Agents never hold the keys to their own record or brake.
2. **The customer holds the evidence.** Logs live in the customer's own bucket with object lock, or anchored in a transparency log, so the record holds up even against the vendor.
3. **Orchestrate, don't replace.** Pull the levers platforms already expose; never become another identity provider or gateway.
4. **Recording never blocks; the brake fails closed.** If the recorder is down, agents keep working and someone gets paged. If the brake can't confirm a lever fired, it treats that path as live.
5. **Open source at the core.** Security teams can read exactly what runs inside their stack.
6. **Score, don't convict.** Persistent problem solving and malice look alike, so raise a risk score and page a human unless the customer's policy says stop.

The stack

Use a memory safe language wherever attackers will poke, boring proven infrastructure everywhere else, and make every part customers must trust runnable in their own cloud. The table follows the architecture above, top to bottom.

Part	Pick	Why
SDK in each agent	Python and TypeScript, built on OpenTelemetry	Where agent frameworks live; standard spans plus Wake's provenance fields
MCP and A2A proxy	Rust, built on agentgateway	An Apache licensed Rust proxy in the Linux Foundation's Agentic AI Foundation that already speaks MCP and A2A, so Wake adds signing and the brake instead of writing a gateway
Memory adapter	Thin wrappers in the SDKs for common memory stores and memory files	Every write gets an origin label before it lands
Ingestion	OpenTelemetry Collector with a custom Go processor	Batching, retries and exporters for free; signatures are checked and provenance extracted there
Signed log	Trillian Tessera, writing to the customer's bucket with object lock	The tile based log library Sigstore moved Rekor v2 onto (Sigstore); cheap to run and checkable by third parties
Provenance graph	Postgres for metadata and causal edges, ClickHouse for raw events	Recursive queries cover the graph until a graph database is clearly needed; ClickHouse is built for trace volume
Detect	Cedar policies inside the proxy, rules over ClickHouse, and out of band monitors from more than one lab	Cedar is analyzable and is what AWS uses for AgentCore Policy, so policies can compile to AWS later

Part	Pick	Why
Brake	Temporal workflows with Go workers calling each lever	Durable fan out with retries and verification, so a revocation never fails silently
Identity and keys	SPIFFE/SPIRE plus cloud KMS, with customer held keys as an option	Short lived identities for every capture component; agents never hold signing keys
Dashboard	Next.js and React Flow in a Turborepo	Familiar tools from Clavr; React Flow draws the provenance graph
Deployment	Containers, Helm and Terraform, with the hosted control plane on GCP	Customers run the data plane in AWS, Azure or GCP; the control plane runs on Cloud Run and Cloud SQL
Shipping it safely	Sigstore signed releases, SLSA provenance, SBOMs, a fuzzed proxy and an early SOC 2	Wake becomes the most attractive target in every customer's stack

That's four languages, each where it's strongest: Rust for the proxy, Go for the collector and the brake, TypeScript and Python for the SDKs and the dashboard. Use the managed versions of ClickHouse and Temporal until customers need everything self hosted. Skip Kafka, a graph database, your own identity provider and your own policy language for now, and never let the brake run inside an agent's own process.

Who it's for

Three groups touch the product: the people who buy it, the people who use it every day, and the people who rely on its records without ever logging in.

Who	Where they sit	What they need	What they get
Head of platform or CTO (buyer)	AI native company running agents for enterprise customers	Ship more autonomous features without an incident or a stalled deal	One install that records, stops and proves across the whole stack

Who	Where they sit	What they need	What they get
Engineer on call (daily user)	Same company	Answer what the agents did, and why, in minutes	The provenance view, the brake and the downstream view
Security reviewer (influencer)	The enterprise buying those agents	Proof the vendor can audit and stop its agents	Evidence packs and a trust page they can check
CISO and platform team (later buyer)	Enterprises and fintechs running agents from several vendors	One record and one stop across vendors, plus evidence for DORA, the EU AI Act and examiners	The control plane across vendors
Auditors and insurers (ecosystem)	AIUC-1 auditors, AI insurers, bank examiners	Records they can trust without trusting the vendor	Signed logs the customer holds, mapped to the controls they test

The ideal first customer is a Series A to C AI native company whose agents take real actions on code, money or customer data, with at least two model vendors or frameworks in its stack, enterprise customers sending AI security questionnaires, and an engineering leader who has already lived through an agent incident.

Not a fit yet: chatbots with no tools, companies all in on one platform's agents (Agent 365 or AgentCore may be enough for them), and banks as direct buyers in year one.

Roadmap at a glance



Roadmap · 6 phases over 36 months, gates as diamonds

The early phases are short on purpose: each is a cheap test before the next one spends real money and time.

What ships in each phase

Each phase ships something a customer can use and ends in a gate. The revenue figures are targets to calibrate against, not forecasts.

Phase	Months	What ships	Gate to move on
Validate	0 to 1	A written release from Microsoft or an exit plan, 20 interviews, a game day on Clavr, a trademark check on Wake, 3 design partners chosen	Release in hand; 5 teams with a real incident or stalled deal; 3 design partners committed
Record	1 to 3	Open source SDKs for the Claude Agent SDK, OpenAI Agents SDK and LangGraph; MCP and A2A proxy built on agentgateway; memory adapter; signed log; provenance view	Live in 3 partners' staging; traces stitched across agents; one real issue caught

Phase	Months	What ships	Gate to move on
Brake	3 to 6	A brake with three levers (proxy deny, token revocation at the top providers, sandbox freeze on E2B or Modal), downstream view, memory quarantine, first paid pilots	A partner's fleet stopped and verified in under a minute during a game day; 2 to 5 paid pilots
Prove	6 to 12	Evidence packs for the OWASP Agentic Top 10, EU AI Act, AIUC-1 and AI questionnaires; trust pages; 10 or more levers; detection rules; a self serve Team plan; SOC 2 Type II	20 paying customers; about $500K ARR; at least one security review closed with an evidence pack
Contain	12 to 18	Origin labels and flow policies that stop untrusted content from triggering privileged actions; memory integrity with gated writes and rollback; blast radius replay; private deployment; SIEM export	50 customers; about $3M ARR; a first enterprise contract over $150K; a first financial services customer through an AI vendor
Platform	18 to 36	Policy compiled to each platform (Cedar, Agent 365, Google); consent and delegation for long running agents; insurer and auditor integrations; detection trained on incidents across customers	An insurer or auditor accepts the records as evidence; $10M or more ARR

Business value

Customers buy it to avoid three costs they can name: incidents, slow enterprise deals and risks insurers won't cover. The company sells into the fastest growing slice of security spending, with real exits along the way.

For customers

Buyer	What they get	The evidence
AI native vendor	Shorter security reviews, room to ship more autonomy, a path to insurance	Each unanswered gap in an AI questionnaire adds two to four weeks to a deal (Promise Legal); AIUC-1 certification now backs AI cover (SiliconANGLE)
Enterprise or fintech running agents	Containment across vendors and evidence for regulators	The average breach cost $4.99M in IBM's 2026 study, and 92% of firms with AI incidents had no AI access controls (Help Net Security); EU AI Act halt and logging duties apply from December 2, 2027 (Lewis Silkin); DORA has applied since January 17, 2025 (Jones Day)
Bank buying agents from AI vendors	Audit rights and a stop button without months of contract talks	In Bank of England roundtables, banks said contract talks with AI vendors drag and that risk management should shift to monitoring and guardrails (Asian Banker)

A quick value test for an AI native vendor, as an illustration. If a $200K a year enterprise deal slips four weeks over agent security questions, about $15K of revenue moves out with it. Ten slipped deals a year is roughly $150K delayed, before counting the deals that die, against a product priced at $12K to $60K a year.

For the company

- **The market is small and compounding.** Gartner puts agentic AI spending at $201.9B in 2026 and $752.7B by 2029, and its narrower "securing AI" segment at $2.8B growing to $11.6B by 2029 (Software Strategies; a sister post dates the $2.8B to 2025). It also expects guardian agents to take at least 10% to 15% of the agentic AI market by 2030 (Gartner).

- **The path to $100M is plausible.** About 1,000 AI native customers at $40K a year plus about 400 enterprises at $150K a year gets there, which is under 1% of Gartner's 2029 securing AI figure.
- **There are good outcomes before the best one.** Strategic exits in agent and AI security mostly landed between about $100M and $650M, with Oasis at $1B (Gupta ledger, SecurityWeek). Outcomes past $1B, like Wiz and CyberArk, came from becoming a system of record, which is what the Prove and Platform phases build toward.

Pricing and packaging

Price per protected agent and governed events, never per seat. Microsoft anchors seats at $15 per user a month, and the value here grows with agents and actions, not people.

Package	From phase	For	Includes	Starting hypothesis
Open source recorder	Record	Anyone	SDKs, proxy, memory adapter, a self hosted signed log	Free, always
Design partner pilot	Brake	The first five customers	Hosted log, provenance view, brake, hands on setup	$1,000 to $3,000 a month
Team	Prove	AI native startups	All of the above plus evidence packs, a trust page and 10 or more levers	About $1,000 to $5,000 a month: a platform fee plus protected agents and events
Enterprise	Contain	Larger AI companies, fintechs and enterprises	The Contain module, private deployment, SIEM export, custom retention, SSO	$75K to $250K a year

Package	From phase	For	Includes	Starting hypothesis
Platform modules	Platform	Enterprises with mixed fleets	Policy across platforms, consent and delegation, insurer and auditor connections	Priced per module

For reference, Langfuse Enterprise lists at $2,499 a month (Langfuse), LangSmith charges about $2.50 per 1,000 traces (Morph), Glacis sells signed AI records at $49 and $499 a month (GeekWire), and Agent 365 lists at $15 per user a month (Licensing School).

Test the meter during the Brake phase: offer per protected agent to some design partners and per million events to others, and keep the one that tracks the value they describe.

Go to market

Earn trust with open source and research, win AI native companies through their stuck security reviews, then follow their customers into fintech and the enterprise.

Phase	Who we sell to	How we reach them	Proof point we need
Validate and Record	Design partners: AI native teams running multiagent systems, plus one or two teams running hundreds of agents	Founder network, Clavr as the first test bed, outreach to teams that have written publicly about agent incidents	3 design partners using it weekly
Brake	The same partners, converted to paid pilots	Game days that simulate a compromised agent and time the stop	A fleet stopped and verified in under a minute
Prove	AI native companies stuck in enterprise security reviews	Open source launch, published attack research, contributions to OpenTelemetry and A2A tracing, partnerships with AIUC-1 auditors	A security review closed with an evidence pack

Phase	Who we sell to	How we reach them	Proof point we need
Contain	First vertical: AI vendors selling agents to banks and fintechs, plus fintechs directly	Case studies from Prove, evidence packs for DORA and the EU AI Act, insurer referrals	A financial services customer won through an AI vendor
Platform	CISOs and platform teams with mixed agent fleets	Partnerships with insurers, auditors and identity providers; cloud marketplaces	An insurer or auditor that names the records as accepted evidence

Financial services, specifically. Banks' trouble with customers' personal agents isn't this product's problem to solve; card networks and identity vendors are already on it. The fit is governing the agents banks and fintechs run themselves, sold through the AI vendors whose bank deals stall on audit and liability terms.

Team, funding and metrics

Stay tiny until the brake works, raise only enough to reach the next gate, and judge the product by how fast and how completely it stops a fleet.

Team and funding by phase

Phase	Team	Money
Validate	Founder, ideally with a security minded cofounder lined up	Personal runway; no raise
Record	Founders plus coding agents	Personal runway, or a small angel round once the Microsoft question is settled
Brake	Two engineers join: one for the proxy and the levers, one for security research	A preseed on design partner usage and the Validate evidence
Prove	A developer advocate or founding account executive; SOC 2 Type II completed	A seed on paid pilots and early ARR

Phase	Team	Money
Contain	Security research, solutions engineering and enterprise sales	A Series A around the Contain gate
Platform	Partnerships and a standards presence	Growth plus later rounds

Size each raise to reach the next gate plus six months of runway.

Metrics that matter

Metric	Why it matters	Target
Time to stop a fleet, verified	It's the core promise	Under 60 seconds by the Brake gate, under 10 seconds by Contain
Agent actions with complete provenance across hops	Tracing and containment fail without it	Over 95% for design partners by the Record gate
Levers integrated	The brake's reach is the moat	3, then 10 or more, then 25 or more
Time to answer an AI security questionnaire	It's the buyer's pain	From weeks to under a day with an evidence pack
Real incidents caught per customer	Proof the product earns its keep	At least one per design partner per quarter
ARR, customers and net revenue retention	Business health	Per the phase gates, and net retention above 120% once the Team plan is live

Risks and dependencies

The first risk is ownership: until Microsoft releases the IP or the founder leaves, the company may not own what it builds.

Risk	What could happen	Mitigation
IP ownership	Washington's RCW 49.44.140 doesn't protect inventions that relate directly to the employer's business (statute text), and Microsoft sells agent governance through Agent 365, Entra Agent ID and the Agent Governance Toolkit	A written release or an exit before product code; an employment lawyer; no Microsoft devices, accounts or tools
Platform bundling	Agent 365, AgentCore Policy, Okta and ServiceNow make good enough controls standard for their own agents	Pull their levers instead of competing; win on reach across vendors, independence and evidence
Halt APIs get restricted	Clouds or labs limit the revocation and disable hooks the brake depends on	Lean on standards like Shared Signals and OAuth revocation, favor credentials the customer owns, and build platform relationships early
Labs build their own tamper resistant monitors	Monitoring inside each lab's runtime looks good enough	Coverage across labs and logs the customer holds; a referee can't be one of the players
A funded rival assembles the loop first	Vorlon, Zenity ($125M Series C), Onyx ($113M) or a suite builder like Cisco or Palo Alto	Go deeper on provenance and blast radius across agents, in the AI native segment the suites don't target
Multiagent adoption is slower than hoped	Few customers run real fleets yet	Sell to single agents with tools first and make multiagent the differentiator
Trust deficit	Security buyers hesitate to buy from a tiny vendor	Open source code, logs the customer holds, an early SOC 2 and a security minded cofounder

Risk	What could happen	Mitigation
Focus	Plug, Clavr, Mayo and a full time job compete for the same hours	Decide what to pause before the Record phase
Name and trademark	Wake is a common word, and Awake Security, now part of Arista, holds trademarks in security software	A trademark search before any branding spend; register as Wake Labs; use a domain like wake.dev or usewake.com

Dependencies. OpenTelemetry's agent conventions are still marked Development and A2A has no standard trace propagation yet (A2A issue 2103), so the recorder has to stitch traces across agents itself until those land. That's work, and it's also a moat while it lasts.

Open questions

These decide pricing, packaging and the first levers, so answer them with design partners during Validate and Record instead of guessing.

- [ ] Who owns the budget: the platform team, security, or the leader whose deals are stuck?
- [ ] Should the log live with us by default, or in the customer's own bucket?
- [ ] Which three levers matter most to the first design partners?
- [ ] Per protected agent or per million events: which meter tracks the value customers feel?
- [ ] Will Microsoft, AWS, Google, Okta and the labs let a third party pull their disable and revocation hooks at fleet scale?
- [ ] Which evidence formats do AIUC-1 auditors, insurers and bank examiners actually accept?
- [ ] How much detection should come from us versus the customer's own SIEM?
- [ ] When does a customer's setup become multiagent enough to need containment across agents?

Sources

Figures are as of October 26, 2026. The full market research, with more sources, is in What to build for the multiagent era.

- **Problem and timing:** OpenAI agents switched off their own safeguards, Cline post mortem, Bad Memory, Project Glasswing update, KPMG AI pulse, Stripe's agent PRs
- **Existing tools:** Rencore on Agent 365, AWS AgentCore Policy, Okta for AI Agents, Microsoft Agent Governance Toolkit, Straiker, Rubrik Agent Rewind, Vorlon
- **Value and regulation:** IBM 2026 breach study, AI questionnaires and deal delays, EU AI Act Article 14, Article 26, Digital Omnibus timeline, DORA, Bank of England roundtables, AIUC, insurer exclusions
- **Market and outcomes:** Gartner spending forecasts, Gartner on guardian agents, acquisition ledger, Cyera and Oasis, Onyx, Zenity
- **Pricing references:** Langfuse, observability pricing roundup, Glacis, Agent 365 pricing
- **Standards and legal:** A2A tracing proposal, RCW 49.44.140 text
- **Name and stack:** agentgateway FAQ, Rekor v2 on Trillian Tessera, Awake Security trademarks